



Cambridge (CIE) IGCSE English Language



Your notes

Paper 1

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Overview

Paper 1 is the compulsory paper for the CIE IGCSE English Language course. You *must* take Paper 1, but for the rest of the IGCSE you may either be sitting Paper 2 or completing a coursework portfolio.

Paper 1 overview

The Paper 1 exam is 2 hours long and you will have three questions to answer, although questions 1 and 2 are further divided into sub-questions. The exam is worth 80 marks. These marks are divided into two skills – reading and writing – as follows:

- Total marks for reading = 65
- Total marks for writing = 15

As well as your question paper and answer booklet, you will also be given an insert containing the three texts you will use to answer the questions on the exam paper. All three texts will be on a similar topic.

CIE recommends that you spend 15 minutes reading the texts, and approximately 30–35 minutes responding to each question. However, as each question makes different demands on you in the exam and are worth different marks, we suggest that you consider the following timings for this exam paper:

Question	Marks	Timing (including reading time)
Question 1(a–e)	15	15–20 minutes
Question 1(f)	15	20 minutes
Question 2(a–c)	10	15 minutes
Question 2(d)	15	20 minutes
Question 3	25	40 minutes

Paper 1 breakdown

Question number	Type of question	What you are asked to do
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Question 1(a-e)	Comprehension	Read Text A
		Respond to a series of sub-questions
Question 1(f)	Summary	Read Text B
		Write a summary of no more than 120 words based on the text
Question 2(a-c)	Short-answer questions	Read Text C
		Respond to a series of sub-questions
Question 2(d)	Language task	Read Text C
		Write 200–300 words in response to a question focused on certain paragraphs in Text C
		Select three relevant examples of interesting uses of language from each of the paragraphs specified
		Analyse these examples to show how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effects
Question 3	Extended response to reading	Read Text C
		Write 250–350 words in response to the task
		Use and develop ideas and details from Text C
		Write in your own words in one of the following formats: letter, report, journal, speech, interview or article

What skills are being assessed

There are only two assessment objectives for this IGCSE, each worth 50% of your overall grade. However, these are then divided into the following sub-objectives:



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AO1: read and respond in different ways to different types of text	Sub-objective	What this means
	R1: demonstrate understanding of explicit meanings	Show that you understand the obvious meanings communicated in a text
	R2: demonstrate understanding of implicit meanings and attitudes	Show that you can recognise hints and suggestions in a text to understand the more hidden meanings and attitudes of the writer
	R3: analyse, evaluate and develop facts, ideas and opinions, using appropriate support from the text	- Evaluate and analyse the facts, ideas and opinions you read by using, explaining and developing them - Refer to supporting evidence from the text where appropriate, such as using quotations or references to the text
	R4: demonstrate understanding of how writers achieve effects and influence readers	- Show that you understand how a writer has influenced their reader through their use of language - Consider the deliberate choices a writer has made and why they have made those choices
	R5: select and use information for specific purposes	Select and use relevant and appropriate information from a text to answer the different questions
AO2: write accurately and effectively, using Standard English appropriately	W1: articulate experience and express what is thought, felt and imagined	Write convincingly to convey real and imagined experience, thoughts and feelings
	W2: organise and structure ideas and opinions for deliberate effect	Sequence and connect the ideas and opinions effectively within your written response to interest and influence your reader



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W3: use a range of vocabulary and sentence structures appropriate to context	▪ Use a range of appropriate vocabulary and sentence structures deliberately within each written response to achieve certain effects
W4: use register appropriate to context	▪ Vary your writing to suit the purpose, audience and form of the task
W5: make accurate use of spelling, punctuation and grammar	▪ Write accurately, avoiding spelling, punctuation and grammar errors

You can find detailed notes on how to answer each question on this paper in the following revision guides:

- [Question 1: Comprehension](#)
- [Question 1: Summary](#)
- [Question 2: Short-answer questions](#)
- [Question 2: Language task](#)
- [Question 3: Extended response](#)